

ANSWER KEY AND EXPLANATION

1. (c) is the correct answer.
2. (d) is the correct answer.
3. (c) is the correct answer.
4. (b) is the correct answer.
5. (d) is the correct answer.
6. (b) is the correct answer.
7. (c) is the correct answer.
8. (a) is the correct answer.
9. (d) is the correct answer.
10. (d) is the correct answer.
11. (b) is the correct answer.
12. (a) is the correct answer.
13. (a) A This option directly targets the flaw in Ms. Kapoor's reasoning. She implies that Mr. Singh's personal preference for luxury goods might cloud his professional judgment regarding the economic policy on luxury goods. However, it's a flawed assumption to believe that personal preferences always affect professional objectivity. Professionals, especially economists, are often trained to separate personal biases from their professional analysis. Thus, this option correctly identifies the reasoning flaw in Ms. Kapoor's argument.
B) This option is unrelated to the flaw in Ms. Kapoor's reasoning. The main issue with her argument is about questioning Mr. Singh's objectivity due to his personal preferences, not the lack of statistical data. Additionally, Ms. Kapoor herself does not make a direct claim about the effectiveness of the tax increase; she only comments on Mr. Singh's suggestion.
C) While this statement might be true in a general sense, it doesn't directly address the specific flaw in Ms. Kapoor's reasoning regarding Mr. Singh's suggestion. The argument she presents is not about the potential biases of economists in general, but specifically about whether Mr. Singh's personal preference for luxury goods impacts his professional suggestion.
D) This option focuses on the potential outcomes of the policy suggestion, not on the flaw in Ms. Kapoor's reasoning about Mr. Singh's bias. The core of the flawed reasoning is about questioning Mr. Singh's objectivity, not about evaluating the direct economic implications of his suggestion.
14. (c) The passage claims that Julius Caesar was killed because all Roman citizens hated him. However, the only evidence given to support this idea is the historical documents referring to his death, in which only his friend Brutus and other politicians are mentioned. This is a very limited sample of the population.
Question Type: Reasoning strategy
Correct answer: C. The group that killed Caesar does not represent all Roman citizens.
(a) The killers are samples of the Roman population and not the other way around.
(b) The passage makes no argument for any course of action.
(c) Historical documents are likely to be highly authoritative.
15. (c) Option A points out a potential limitation in the survey's location but does not directly address the specific flaw in the reasoning, which is about the representativeness of the respondents.
Option B identifies a potential variability in satisfaction levels at different times, which is a relevant consideration but not the primary flaw in the argument. The main issue is not when the survey was conducted, but who was surveyed.
Option C is the correct answer as it identifies the critical flaw: people who do not use public transportation due to dissatisfaction were likely not present at the bus terminal to participate in the survey. This oversight means the survey results may not accurately represent the views of all city residents.
Option D points out a valid concern in the argument's assumption but does not directly address the flaw regarding the representativeness of the survey sample. The main issue is about who was surveyed, not the indicators of the transportation system meeting needs.
In summary, Option C most accurately identifies the flaw in the reasoning by highlighting the potential exclusion of dissatisfied non-users of public transportation from the survey.
16. (b) Option A points out an issue with assuming a direct solution to a complex problem, which is relevant but does not directly address the flaw in the argument, which is about the exclusivity of the presented options.
Option B is the correct answer as it identifies the flaw of a false dilemma or limited options. The argument presents only two possibilities (building more roads or facing economic decline) and ignores other potential solutions to traffic congestion.
Option C addresses the potential oversights of the argument regarding environmental and social impacts, which is a valid point but not the primary flaw in the reasoning. The main issue is about the argument's limited scope of solutions.
Option D points out a flaw in assuming only one negative outcome (economic decline) if more roads are not built. This is a relevant consideration but does not directly address the flaw in the argument, which is about the limited options presented as solutions.
In summary, Option B most accurately identifies the flaw in the reasoning by highlighting the argument's failure to consider other possible solutions to traffic congestion beyond just building more roads.
17. (a) A. This is the correct answer. The politician's argument commits the logical flaw of oversimplification. It assumes a direct and exclusive causation relationship between economic prosperity (GDP) and healthcare quality. In reality, healthcare quality is influenced by a variety of factors including but not limited to economic prosperity. These factors can include government policies, cultural attitudes towards health, public health initiatives, and the availability of trained healthcare professionals. By attributing healthcare quality only to economic prosperity, the politician overlooks these other significant factors.
B. This option points out another logical flaw, which is the failure to consider different healthcare models and infrastructures. However, it is more about the neglect of comparative analysis rather than oversimplification of the



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relationship between GDP and healthcare quality. While relevant, it doesn't directly address the core logical flaw in the politician's reasoning as stated in the question.

C. This option highlights another important aspect, suggesting that healthcare improvements can happen without global growth. It challenges the assumption that global growth is a prerequisite for healthcare advancement which is irrelevant to the passage as it confines itself to economic growth.

D. This option also identifies a logical flaw, which is the fallacy of a single cause. It suggests that the politician is advocating for only one path (economic growth) to improve healthcare, disregarding other methods like policy reform or public health initiatives. However, this is more about the narrowness of the proposed solution rather than the oversimplified relationship between GDP and healthcare quality.

18. (b) Option A points out a potential issue with the timeframe for assessing the effectiveness of the security measures, which is a valid consideration but not the primary flaw in the reasoning. The main flaw is about how the evidence is interpreted.

Option B is the correct answer as it directly addresses the logical fallacy in the argument. The reasoning incorrectly uses the absence of evidence (no reports of unauthorized access) as proof that the security measures are effective, which is a flawed conclusion.

Option C highlights a potential oversight in considering other factors that might influence the outcome. While this is an important consideration, it doesn't directly address the central flaw of interpreting the absence of evidence as evidence of absence.

Option D raises a concern about the fool proof-ness of the security measures, which is not a relevant point. It doesn't pinpoint the primary flaw, which is about how the lack of reported incidents is interpreted as proof of effectiveness.

The key flaw in the argument is the assumption that because there is no evidence of unauthorized access, it conclusively proves the effectiveness of the security measures, which is why Option B is the most accurate choice.

19. (a) Option A is the correct answer. It identifies the circular nature of the argument: the company is the industry leader because it's innovative, and it's innovative because it's the industry leader. This reasoning is circular because it uses its own conclusion as a premise without providing independent evidence.

Option B points out the lack of empirical evidence, which is a valid critique but doesn't address the primary logical flaw in the argument, which is circular reasoning.

Option C raises a concern about potential competition and alternative sources of innovation, which is a relevant point but again doesn't directly address the flaw of circular reasoning in the argument.

Option D suggests a potential misinterpretation of what it means to be an industry leader. While this is an important consideration, it does not directly identify the circular reasoning present in the argument.

The key flaw in the argument is using its own assertions to validate itself, forming a loop that does not provide any

external justification for its claims, which is why Option A is the most accurate choice.

20. (a) Option A is the correct answer. It points out the flaw of assuming a direct causal relationship (causation) based solely on the occurrence of two events together (correlation) - the switch to a four-day workweek and an increase in productivity. This overlooks other possible factors that might have contributed to the productivity increase.

Option B highlights the potential influence of external factors like market trends or client demands, which is a valid consideration but does not take into account about the "unrelated" factors; this option mentions about related factors while they are actually "unrelated" in reality. Moreover, it doesn't directly address the primary logical flaw of mistaking correlation for causation in the company's reasoning.

Option C raises a concern about the long-term impacts versus immediate outcomes, which is important for overall analysis but does not identify the specific reasoning flaw in the argument presented, which is about the correlation-causation error.

Option D points out an assumption about the relationship between employee satisfaction and productivity. While this is an interesting aspect, it does not directly address the flaw in the argument, which is the erroneous leap from correlation to causation regarding the workweek change and productivity increase.

The key issue in the management's argument is the mistaken belief that because the increase in productivity coincided with the implementation of the four-day workweek, the latter must have caused the former, without adequately considering other contributing factors. This is why Option A most accurately identifies the flaw in the reasoning.

21. (b) 'Even though the yield of oranges is higher in Nashville County, orchard owners still focus on growing more bananas. One reason for this could be the fact that bananas sell for a much higher price than do oranges, something which could more than make up for the smaller banana yield. B gives us one such option. If the selling price of bananas is six times that of oranges then, despite the yield of oranges being higher, it still makes sense to grown bananas.

A) All the more reason to grow oranges as they can be exported.

B) The correct answer.

C) If the fertilizer requirement is the same then why are more bananas being grown, when the yield of oranges is higher?

D) the question is, 'why are they doing so?'

22. (d) Neither choice (a) nor (b) explain lack of demand. Choice (c) provides past data but does not explain the current situation. Choice (d) states that the north eastern states do not fall under the region in which NTPC supplies power. Now the situation may be that there is no demand from southern states, which explains NTPC's decision and that there is not sufficient power supply from Northern Grid to the north eastern states. Thus (d) explains the paradox.

23. (a) This passage explains that it is usually to a patient's benefit to have broken bones treated professionally by a



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medical doctor. However, it contends that there are a number of doctors who consistently recommend that their patients get no treatment at all for broken bones in certain appendages. Why would this be? One of the answer choices will provide you with a good reason.

Question stem: It asks you to explain the paradox inherent in the squib.

Correct answer: A. This choice would definitely explain why some doctors would never advise their patients to receive treatment for certain kinds of broken bones. For example, many bones in the foot generally heal better without surgery or any type of treatment, so it would make sense that podiatrists often recommend that their patients leave broken foot bones untreated.

(B) If this were the case, then most broken bones would not need to be treated and set by a doctor to heal properly. But this would go against one of the statements we are trying to reconcile, namely, the first part of the squib, which states that most broken bones do need to be treated and set by a doctor.

(C) The squib does not mention surgery, only bone setting and treatment (which may or may not include surgery), so this answer choice does not seem entirely relevant.

(D) This is true, and it would make sense that doctors would try to cater to the desires of their patients—but not to the extent that would be harmful to them. Therefore, it seems that this fact would be negligible in determining whether or not to recommend surgery to a patient.

24. (b) This passage presents a conflict between the claims of Colombian scientists and a survey based on the current rate of rainforest depletion. Colombian scientists claim that the rainforest will be destroyed in a much shorter time period than the survey suggests. You must choose the answer choice that explains this discrepancy.

Question stem: It asks you to reconcile the Colombian scientists' conclusion with the survey's projection.

Correct answer: B. A survey that merely extrapolated linearly using the current rate of depletion would not reflect

new logging technologies that will likely speed up the deforestation process. Because the scientists' analysis takes these new technologies into account, its projected date for total deforestation is much sooner.

(A) This is a true statement since the scientists live in Colombia and will personally be disadvantaged by the destruction of their rainforest. However, this is not a reason for them to sacrifice their professional credibility by making claims unsupported by facts.

(C) If farmers actually stopped contributing to deforestation, then the rate of deforestation would slow and scientists would likely project a later date for complete deforestation than the date in the survey.

(D) Before even analyzing this statement, we must note that it is hypothetical. Hypothetical statements are almost never correct answers to these questions because the question stem asks for an explanation, not a possible explanation. That aside, if the rate of deforestation were reduced, it would take more than 25 years for the forests to be fully depleted.

25. (c) Oil spills have been occurring near Spain, and it appears that the Spanish are tired of them. Therefore, when this particular captain asked for harbor in order to fix his spill, his request was rejected. The question asks us to choose a likely reason for the rejection.

Question stem: Explain the actions of the Spanish government.

Correct answer: C. The Spanish government most likely preferred that the damage from the leaky oil barge occur anywhere but in Spanish waters.

(A) This fact would actually have the opposite effect: It would incentivize people to bring the barge closer to shore.

(B) The preferences of a particular group of people who are not actually in charge of the situation have no bearing.

(D) This fact is not a reason why Spain would refuse to receive the ship. Most bad things eventually get worse if left untreated, but we do not know enough of the facts to say when the "eventually" in this situation would occur.



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